

WITH DETECTIVE HOLLOWAY'S COMPLIMENTS

THE FROSTMERE BONUS CASE FILE



Six brand-new cosy cases for a Frostmere Christmas, free for every reader — with full solutions. Read each case, work the word search, and let the unused letters name the guilty. No sign-up, no catch. Mind the snow.

Death at the Orchard

DIFFICULTY — CONSTABLE



DETECTIVE JUNE HOLLOWAY began with the one who found COLONEL DACE, who kept the war graves free of weeds, in the Orchard, the Poison still where it had dropped. The bell-ringers had fallen silent, and no one asked them to begin again. Holloway drew the three of them out of the draught, and began. Yale, the vicar, was nowhere anyone could name when it happened, alone could doctor the cup without a soul the wiser, and had made peace over the old quarrel only weeks before. Gwendolen, the judge, saw the manor contract slipping to the victim's hands, was away at the county town on business all afternoon, and was reckoned harmless enough by all. Kenneth, the grocer, had a buried scandal the victim threatened to unwrap at the party. He was said by more than one to have been away at the time, and held the keys to where the Poison was locked away. Holloway, who never refused a second cup, took her time over it. And there, at the last, was the proof: the cordial bottle had been wiped where a thumb should have smudged it.

THE SUSPECTS

Yale (the vicar), **Gwendolen** (the judge), **Kenneth** (the grocer)

YOUR VERDICT

Killer

Weapon

Location

CASE NO. I — THE PUZZLE

DIFFICULTY — CONSTABLE

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I	T	P	R	E	S	E	R	V	E	S	W
A	S	O	E	K	A	L	P	O	O	H	E
V	T	I	X	N	N	H	U	S	H	E	D
I	R	S	P	S	C	O	N	E	S	E	T
C	E	O	O	W	H	W	C	I	T	Y	B
A	S	N	S	O	R	C	H	A	R	D	A
R	T	H	U	R	T	H	B	E	P	D	N
A	L	O	R	R	I	S	O	O	N	O	N
G	E	A	E	A	T	T	W	H	E	H	E
E	S	T	O	M	B	O	L	A	O	S	R
R	C	C	A	K	E	S	T	A	L	L	S
H	C	O	C	O	N	U	T	S	A	R	D

BANNERS
CAKE-STALL
COCONUTS
EXPOSURE

HOOPLA
HUSHED
MARROWS
ORCHARD

POISON
PRESERVES
PUNCHBOWL
SCONES

SHODDY
TOMBOLA
TRESTLES
VICARAGE

Every word hides once. The unused letters spell the verdict.

The Study Affair

DIFFICULTY — CONSTABLE



THE STUDY STOOD silent when MRS. BIRCH, who kept the war memorial railings black and bright, was found there at last, the Corkscrew not far from the body. The Yule log had burned down to a sullen red eye on the wide hearth. Holloway gathered the three who had been near. Gwen, the cook, had been written back into the will to be read on Boxing Day. She knew the Corkscrew and could lay hands on it in a moment, and was off on some errand she would not explain. Vernon, the solicitor, kept the Corkscrew near his hand the whole evening, could not say, when pressed, where he had stood, and had buried the quarrel and shaken hands on it. Theodora, the gardener, had a letter her would pay any Christmas to keep buried, had no way to reach the Corkscrew unwatched, and had no part in the day's quarrels. Put out the candles on the innocent, and one window stays lit.

THE SUSPECTS

Gwen (the cook), **Vernon** (the solicitor), **Theodora** (the gardener)

YOUR VERDICT

Killer

Weapon

Location

CASE NO. II — THE PUZZLE

DIFFICULTY — CONSTABLE

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F	I	W	E	R	C	S	K	R	O	C	T
O	L	I	N	E	N	F	O	L	D	W	D
O	A	L	S	T	E	T	A	T	S	E	O
T	H	L	G	S	W	E	N	W	I	T	V
M	T	O	P	I	A	R	Y	H	T	M	E
A	R	W	H	N	E	C	O	R	K	O	C
N	A	S	C	A	G	A	Z	E	B	O	O
R	E	E	W	B	Y	D	U	T	S	L	T
C	H	A	N	D	E	L	I	E	R	R	E
A	T	T	D	E	M	A	N	D	S	I	H
E	S	R	O	T	I	D	E	R	C	E	T
U	D	T	A	P	E	S	T	R	Y	H	Y

BANISTER
CHANDELIER
CORKSCREW
CREDITOR

DEMANDS
DOVECOTE
ESTATE
FOOTMAN

GAZEBO
HEARTH
HEIRLOOM
LINENFOLD

STUDY
TAPESTRY
TOPIARY
WILLOW

Every word hides once. The unused letters spell the verdict.

Trouble at the Cellar

DIFFICULTY — INSPECTOR



IN THE HUSH after the carols, MISS CRANE, who knew which floorboard in the hall to avoid, was found in the Cellar, the Poison fallen close by. More than one handkerchief was out before the church bell tolled the hour. Holloway took the four in turn, the way she took her tea — without hurry. Pudding, the inspector's marmalade cat, sat washing one paw on the warm hearth, supremely unbothered. Lilian, the baker, had a letter her would pay any Christmas to keep buried, was served by another's hand all evening, and kept much to her own affairs. Gideon, the apprentice, was hounded for a card-debt the victim would not forgive over the season, knew the Poison well enough, and had not yet arrived when it happened. Estelle, the supplier, had lost the carol-prize to the dead three Christmases running, had charge of the very cup the Poison went into, and had wandered off alone just as the clock struck. Damaris, the rival, had no soul to vouch for her whereabouts, moved freely about the still-room and knew the Poison's measure, and depended on the victim's goodwill and knew it well. What the candle-light showed was small but certain: a corner of the sugar-paper had been torn and the torn piece pocketed.

THE SUSPECTS

Estelle (the supplier), **Lilian** (the baker), **Gideon** (the apprentice), **Damaris** (the rival)

YOUR VERDICT

Killer

Weapon

Location

CASE NO. III — THE PUZZLE

DIFFICULTY — INSPECTOR

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I	T	W	A	S	G	R	I	D	D	L	E
S	E	N	I	P	G	N	I	L	L	O	R
S	T	T	O	E	L	L	S	H	E	W	I
T	F	N	P	S	H	T	N	U	N	H	E
R	A	P	A	B	I	O	O	S	O	S	S
A	O	R	S	R	I	O	R	H	M	R	L
L	L	E	T	E	R	S	P	M	A	I	E
L	R	I	R	A	O	U	A	O	N	A	R
E	A	S	I	D	N	A	C	N	N	L	U
C	G	S	E	V	T	T	H	E	I	C	A
E	U	O	S	A	C	E	L	Y	C	E	L
L	S	D	A	N	S	E	K	A	T	S	R

APRONS
BREADVAN
CELLAR
CINNAMON
CURRANTS

DOSSIER
ECLAIRS
GRIDDLE
HUSH-MONEY
LAURELS

PASTRIES
POISON
ROLLING-PIN
STAKES
SUGARLOAF

Every word hides once. The unused letters spell the verdict.

The Lounge Case

DIFFICULTY — INSPECTOR



DETECTIVE JUNE HOLLOWAY began with the one who found MR. ABLETT — who learned everyone's name in a week — in the Lounge, the Scarf still where it had dropped. Garlands of fir and ribbon were looped along the porch, the revels gone quiet. Holloway's cat Pudding wound once about a table-leg and settled in by the fire to watch. One of the four was lying, and Holloway meant to find which before the bells rang midnight. Drusilla, the steward, had signed the bakery away on a handshake never honoured. She appeared at the outset to be in the clear like the rest, and was both near enough and strong enough to take up the Scarf. Susannah, the champion, had wandered off alone just as the clock struck. She was strong enough, and near enough, to take up the Scarf, and had made peace over the old quarrel only weeks before. Tristan, the member, had buried kin after the victim's careless word one hard winter. He was caught in conversation by the whole card-room and could not break free, and was no stranger to the Scarf. Winnifred, the secretary, saw the manor contract slipping to the victim's hands. She was no great hand at hiding feeling, and had neither the height nor the strength the Scarf called for. When the cleared names fell away, only the guilty stayed.

THE SUSPECTS

Drusilla (the steward), **Tristan** (the member), **Susannah** (the champion), **Winnifred** (the secretary)

YOUR VERDICT

Killer

Weapon

Location

CASE NO. IV — THE PUZZLE

DIFFICULTY — INSPECTOR

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T	I	T	A	E	F	E	D	B	T	W	W
R	D	E	K	C	E	R	W	I	A	S	A
O	D	L	O	U	N	G	E	L	R	U	G
P	S	M	I	L	D	B	L	L	A	K	E
H	R	O	W	I	E	T	R	I	C	H	R
I	E	O	P	O	R	T	R	A	I	T	S
E	H	R	T	H	S	E	B	R	N	S	C
S	T	E	A	R	E	Y	F	D	A	D	T
T	A	K	F	R	A	C	S	S	H	E	Y
L	E	O	O	P	T	N	E	T	A	P	U
N	L	M	W	A	G	E	R	B	O	O	K
G	E	S	E	C	A	L	P	E	R	I	F

BILLIARDS

BRANDY

DEFEAT

FENDER-SEAT

FIREPLACE

LEATHER

LOUNGE

PATENT

PAYBACK

PORTRAITS

SCARF

SMOKE-ROOM

TROPHIES

WAGER-BOOK

WAGERS

WRECKED

Every word hides once. The unused letters spell the verdict.

Murder at the Millroom

DIFFICULTY — INSPECTOR



BY THE TIME Holloway reached the Millroom, word of MRS. INCE, who always had a story for a rainy queue, had thrown the Christmas kitchen into uproar; the Poison lay where it had fallen. The great tree in the hall stood lit, its candles trembling in the draught. Underfoot, Pudding had found the warmest corner of the room and claimed it for the duration. The four sat in the firelight, and Holloway studied each face. Boris, the baker, moved freely about the still-room and knew the Poison's measure, had stepped out alone and told no one where, and had every reason to wish the victim well. Alma, the apprentice, was the only other soul who knew what happened at the frozen weir. She took the very same cup and could not have doctored it, and had kept to the edges of the trouble. Roland, the miller, had a marker the victim refused to tear up before the new year, alone knew the dose, and where the Poison was kept, and was off on some errand he would not explain. Theodora, the supplier, could not forgive being passed over for the dead at the carol service. She had little enough to say for herself, and never went near the cup the Poison was found in. Holloway bent closer by candlelight. A medicine-dropper, wiped clean, lay in the wrong drawer.

THE SUSPECTS

Boris (the baker), **Roland** (the miller), **Alma** (the apprentice),
Theodora (the supplier)

YOUR VERDICT

Killer

Weapon

Location

CASE NO. V — THE PUZZLE

DIFFICULTY — INSPECTOR

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N	A	V	D	A	E	R	B	I	T	W	S
A	S	R	O	L	A	R	N	D	P	W	U
I	T	H	S	T	S	I	T	Y	O	H	G
E	P	O	I	T	S	V	N	E	I	S	A
M	L	E	S	S	E	A	E	A	S	O	R
I	A	C	N	E	N	L	M	S	O	C	L
L	R	L	O	R	T	S	T	T	N	R	O
L	D	A	R	E	I	U	N	R	N	U	A
R	E	I	P	T	W	I	E	A	A	S	F
O	R	R	A	N	T	T	S	T	H	T	E
O	S	S	M	I	I	O	E	L	L	S	R
M	O	O	M	C	U	R	R	A	N	T	S

APRONS
BREADVAN
CRUSTS
CURRANTS
ECLAIRS

INTEREST
LARDERS
MILL-ROOM
POISON
RESENTMENT

RIVAL-SUITOR
SUGARLOAF
TARTLETS
WITNESS
YEAST

Every word hides once. The unused letters spell the verdict.

A Death in the Potshed

DIFFICULTY — CONSTABLE



BY CANDLE-LIGHT DR. MERRIOT, who kept the churchyard tidy unasked, was found in the Potshed, the Statuette fallen where it lay. Icicles hung from the eaves like a row of held breaths. Pudding regarded the gathered company with the calm contempt only a cat can manage. Holloway considered the three who remained behind by the fire. Veronica, the curator, claimed the strip of orchard the dead had fenced off before Advent, was locked out of the room where the Statuette was kept that night, and was thought the least likely of any. Susannah, the student, was both near enough and strong enough to take up the Statuette, slipped from sight in the very hour of the death, and in fact stood to LOSE by the death, not gain. Hubert, the botanist, owed a gambling marker the dead held over him. He had the Statuette within arm's reach and the strength for it, and could give no account of the fatal hour. The unused letters, read in order, will name the rest.

THE SUSPECTS

Hubert (the botanist), **Veronica** (the curator), **Susannah** (the student)

YOUR VERDICT

Killer

Weapon

Location

CASE NO. VI — THE PUZZLE

DIFFICULTY — CONSTABLE

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I	T	E	A	V	E	S	D	R	O	P	S
H	E	D	G	E	R	O	W	W	A	S	T
H	U	S	U	R	V	E	Y	O	R	B	A
E	R	N	T	W	I	T	H	T	H	E	T
W	O	R	R	A	B	L	E	E	H	W	U
S	T	E	A	B	E	E	H	O	U	S	E
T	U	F	A	I	R	E	T	S	I	W	T
K	C	O	H	Y	L	L	O	H	E	T	T
T	E	D	E	H	S	T	O	P	A	T	E
T	R	E	L	L	I	S	E	S	S	O	L
T	H	E	P	C	O	M	P	O	S	T	O
T	S	H	E	D	Y	R	E	K	C	O	R

BEEHOUSE
COMPOST
EAVESDROP
FERNS
HEDGEROW

HOLLYHOCK
LOSSES
POTSHED
ROCKERY
STATUETTE

SURVEYOR
TRELLIS
WHEELBARROW
WISTERIA

Every word hides once. The unused letters spell the verdict.

Solutions

Case 1: Kenneth

Clear the innocents and one name is left to answer for it. The unused letters, read in order, spell the verdict: it was Kenneth, with the poison, at the orchard.

Case 2: Gwen

Clear the innocents and one name is left to answer for it. The unused letters, read in order, spell the verdict: it was Gwen, with the corkscrew, at the study.

Case 3: Estelle

Clear the innocents and one name is left to answer for it. The unused letters, read in order, spell the verdict: it was Estelle, with the poison, at the cellar.

Case 4: Drusilla

Clear the innocents and one name is left to answer for it. The unused letters, read in order, spell the verdict: it was Drusilla, with the scarf, at the lounge.

Case 5: Roland

Clear the innocents and one name is left to answer for it. The unused letters, read in order, spell the verdict: it was Roland, with the poison, at the millroom.

Case 6: Hubert

Clear the innocents and one name is left to answer for it. The unused letters, read in order, spell the verdict: it was Hubert, with the statuette, at the potshed.